

ANDREW YINGXI ZHAO

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EDUCATION

Harvard University – School of Engineering and Applied Science

Master of Science in Data Science, Department of Computer Science (GPA: 4.0/4.0)

Cambridge, MA

Sep. 2025-May. 2027

University of California - San Diego

Bachelor of Science in Data Science (GPA: 4.0/4.0)

San Diego, CA

Sep. 2021-Mar. 2025

Bachelor of Art in Economics (GPA: 3.95/4.0)

EXPERIENCE

Data Smith Lab

Research Assistant

San Diego, CA

Apr. 2024-Jun 2025

- Co-first author on a publication at a top computer security conference; developed a human-centered privacy visualization method and validated through user study, achieving 77% improvement in user interpretation accuracy over existing tools.
- Designed UI/UX graphical representation prototypes in Figma and developed an interactive JavaScript web interface that helped 70+ computer science and data science professionals explore privacy design patterns and frameworks.

iCan Chat

Software Development Engineer Intern

Beijing, China (Remote)

Jun. 2024-Sep. 2024

- Developed secure mobile wallet integration in Swift and React, enabling Visa card registration for e-commerce payments, implementing KYC verification with document/selfie uploads using AWS S3.
- Built a scalable Flask RESTful API to track job execution status in PostgreSQL, featuring real-time monitoring, email notifications, and archiving retention policies, which reduced incident diagnosis time by ~40%.

University of California, San Diego

Teaching Assistant

San Diego, CA

Jan. 2024-Dec. 2024

- Mentored 300+ students in Econometrics. Achieving 100% student satisfaction ratings in end-of-semester evaluations.

PUBLICATIONS

“Teaching Data Science Students to Sketch Privacy Designs through Heuristics.”

IEEE S&P’25 (14.8% acceptance rate)

Jinhe Wen*, Yingxi Zhao*, Wenqian Xu*, Yaxing Yao, Haojian Jin

PROJECTS

macOS Cache Manager

Jul. 2025-Sep 2025

- Designed and implemented an intelligent cache managing tool using Go and JavaScript achieving 97% accuracy in identifying deletable files, processing 50,000+ cache entries across directories with confidence scoring.
- Optimized scanning performance by 300% using Go goroutines and concurrent processing, delivering real-time progress tracking UI and embedded frontend assets for seamless macOS deployment.
- Developed a comprehensive backup/restore system with SHA-256 integrity verification and selective file recovery, reducing accidental data loss risk by 95% compared to traditional cache cleaning tools.

EdTech Platform - for Grace All Star Academy

Apr. 2025-Jun 2025

- Developed a consumer-facing system prototype using Django and MongoDB to support class registration for 150+ students, with automated email notifications powered by AWS SES cloud services via Boto3.
- Developed automated grading tools using LLMs that processed 2,500+ student submissions with 98% accuracy, reducing grading time by over 80%.

GenZ Language Content Moderation System

Sep. 2024-Aug 2025

- Designed and deployed an end-to-end ML content moderation system detecting malicious GenZ language with 95% accuracy, processing 1M+ Reddit-sourced features and achieving <200ms response time for real-time analysis
- Developed a Flask REST API to handle requests for malicious Genz language content detection, implementing secure endpoints for text analysis and model insights with OAuth authentication and CORS configuration.
- Implemented CI/CD pipeline with automated testing, Docker containerization and Render PaaS deployment achieving 99.9% uptime and reducing deployment time from 40 minutes to 5 minutes with integrated monitoring and alerting.

AWARDS

Highest Distinction Honors

Mar. 2025

- Top 1% academic achievement** - Selected as one of <10 students annually across UCSD departments for exceptional academic performance and research contributions.

SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, Java, C++, C#, Golang, Swift, TypeScript, JavaScript, R, SQL, HTML/CSS

Frameworks: React, Django, Hadoop, Spring Boot, Flask, Vue, Node.js, Oracle, Tensorflow, PyTorch

DevOps & Tool: AWS, Apache Spark, Kubernetes, Docker, Git, Redis, Databricks, PostgreSQL, Azure, Jira, REST APIs, CI/CD